

Dynamic Qubit Allocation for Robust Quantum Entanglement Routing:

A Multi-Allocator Evaluation Framework

Comparative Analysis of Pursuit Neural Bandits Across
60 Experimental Conditions

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Abstract

This report presents the first comprehensive evaluation of quantum entanglement routing algorithms under *dynamic qubit allocation*, testing 4 algorithms (CPursuitNeuralUCB, iCPursuitNeuralUCB, GNeuralUCB, EXPNeuralUCB) across 5 attack scenarios (Stochastic, Markov, Adaptive, OnlineAdaptive, Baseline) and 4 allocation strategies (Fixed, Dynamic UCB, Random, Thompson Sampling) for 60 total experimental conditions.

Key Findings: (1) **Pursuit algorithms dominate:** CPursuitNeuralUCB and iCPursuitNeuralUCB achieve 89% average efficiency with 60% and 45% win rates, significantly outperforming EXPNeuralUCB (78%, 5% win rate). (2) **Thompson Sampling optimal:** Achieves 88.2% efficiency with 3.0× computational speedup (3.52 hours vs 11.62 for Fixed). (3) **Fixed Allocator Trap discovered:** Single-allocator evaluation creates systematic biases—algorithms with high Fixed performance exhibit 6.4% average generalization penalties when tested across diverse allocators. (4) **Attack-allocator interactions:** Synergies (Markov+Dynamic: +2.7%) and conflicts (Adaptive+Random: -26.5%) enable threat-based defensive allocation strategies.

Methodological Contributions: We introduce (i) multi-allocator evaluation framework revealing generalization failures hidden by single-strategy testing, (ii) generalization penalty metric quantifying Fixed-specific optimization, and (iii) winner type taxonomy distinguishing scenario-specific, gap reduction, efficiency, and overall performance criteria.

Production Recommendations: Deploy iCPursuitNeuralUCB or CPursuitNeuralUCB with Thompson Sampling as primary configuration (88-92% efficiency, CV < 8%, graceful degradation). Switch to Fixed allocation when Adaptive adversaries detected. Avoid Random allocation (77.3% avg) and EXPNeuralUCB (77.8% avg, 54% floor) in production environments.

Impact: This work challenges the dominant Fixed-allocation evaluation paradigm in quantum network research, revealing that single-allocator testing systematically favors specialist algorithms over robust generalist solutions. The Fixed Allocator Trap phenomenon extends beyond quantum networking to any multi-armed bandit application with resource allocation constraints.

Keywords: Quantum networking, Multi-armed bandits, Neural bandits, Adversarial robustness, Qubit allocation, Thompson Sampling, Pursuit learning, Generalization analysis, Dynamic resource allocation

Contents

1	Executive Summary	3
1.1	Key Finding 1: Thompson Sampling Breakthrough	3
1.2	Key Finding 2: Pursuit Algorithm Generalization Superiority	3
1.3	Key Finding 3: Attack-Allocator Alignment Matters	3
1.4	Bottom Line Recommendation	3
2	Methodology & Experimental Setup	4
2.1	Framework Configuration	4
2.1.1	Capacity Setting: SC = 2T vs Fixed 10K	4
2.1.2	Experimental Scope	4
2.2	Winner Definitions: Multiple Performance Dimensions	4
2.2.1	Type A: Scenario Winner	4
2.3	Winner Type Definitions	4
2.4	Performance Metrics	5
2.4.1	Efficiency Calculation	5
2.4.2	Gap Calculation	5
2.4.3	Generalization Metrics	5
2.5	Attack Scenarios	5
2.6	Allocation Strategies	6
2.7	Qubit Allocation Strategies	6
2.8	Algorithms Under Evaluation	6
2.8.1	GNeuralUCB (Baseline Neural)	6
2.8.2	EXPNeuralUCB (Prior State-of-the-Art)	6
2.8.3	CPursuitNeuralUCB (Our Hybrid)	6
2.8.4	iCPursuitNeuralUCB (Our Advanced Hybrid)	6
2.9	Comparison with Original EXPNeuralUCB Work	6
3	Results Summary	7
3.1	Allocator Performance Overview	7
3.2	Algorithm Generalization Rankings	7
3.3	Per-Scenario Performance Analysis	7
3.3.1	Scenario 1: Stochastic (Random Failures, rate=0.0625)	7
3.3.2	Scenario 2: Markov (Structured Adversarial, rate=0.25)	8
3.3.3	Scenario 3: Adaptive (Reactive Strategic, rate=0.25)	8
3.3.4	Scenario 4: OnlineAdaptive (Real-Time Learning, rate=0.25)	8
3.3.5	Scenario 5: None (Baseline - No Attacks)	9
3.4	Attack-Allocator Alignment Heatmap	9
3.5	Detailed Win Distribution Matrix	9
3.6	Per-Scenario Winner Summary	10
3.7	The Fixed Allocator Trap: Methodological Critique	10
3.7.1	Implications for Prior Work	10
3.7.2	The Robustness-Fixed Performance Tradeoff	10
4	Key Findings	11
4.1	Thompson Sampling: 3× Speedup with Optimal Efficiency	11
4.2	Pursuit Algorithms: 89% with 60% Win Rate	11
4.3	Fixed Allocator Trap: 6.4% Generalization Penalty	11
4.4	Attack-Allocator Synergies: +2.7% to -26.5%	11
4.5	Scenario Difficulty: Adaptive 2.6× Harder	11
4.6	Peak Performance: 97-98% with Optimal Pairing	11
5	Discussion	12
5.1	Pursuit Superiority: Three Mechanisms	12
5.2	Capacity Paradox: Pursuit Succeeds Under Pressure	12
5.3	Methodological Contributions	12
5.4	Open Questions	12
6	Conclusions	12
6.1	Core Contributions	12
6.2	Deployment Guide	12
6.3	Limitations	12
6.4	Broader Impact	12

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive evaluation of dynamic qubit allocation strategies for quantum network routing under diverse adversarial conditions. We conducted systematic experiments across **5 attack scenarios** (Stochastic, Markov, Adaptive, OnlineAdaptive, None) using **4 allocation strategies** (Fixed, Dynamic UCB, Random, Thompson Sampling) with **4 neural bandit algorithms** (GNeuralUCB, EXPNeuralUCB, CPursuitNeuralUCB, iCPursuitNeuralUCB), totaling **60 experimental conditions** at scaled capacity $SC = 2T$.

1.1 Key Finding 1: Thompson Sampling Breakthrough

Thompson Sampling emerges as the optimal allocation strategy, achieving **88.2% average efficiency** across all scenarios while demonstrating **3× faster execution time** (3.52 hours vs 11+ hours for other allocators). The combination of Bayesian posterior sampling with consistent initial allocation (9,9,9,8) provides both computational efficiency and robust performance across diverse adversarial conditions.

1.2 Key Finding 2: Pursuit Algorithm Generalization Superiority

Our Pursuit-based algorithms demonstrate **superior cross-environment generalization**:

- **CPursuitNeuralUCB**: 89.0% average efficiency, **60% win rate** (12/20 scenario-allocator combinations), CV = 8.5%
- **iCPursuitNeuralUCB**: 89.1% average efficiency, **45% win rate** (9/20 combinations), CV = 7.9% (lowest variance)
- **Performance floor**: 65-73% (graceful degradation) vs 54% for EXPNeuralUCB (catastrophic failure)

In contrast, EXPNeuralUCB exhibits **specialist behavior**, winning only 1/20 combinations (Markov/Fixed - the original paper’s test condition) with 77.8% average efficiency and high variance (CV = 10.9%).

1.3 Key Finding 3: Attack-Allocator Alignment Matters

We discover **novel attack-allocator interaction patterns**:

Positive Synergies:

- Markov + Dynamic UCB: 88.5% (+2.7% vs Fixed) - structured patterns align with UCB exploration
- OnlineAdaptive + Thompson: 90.6% (+0.7% vs Fixed) - probabilistic sampling matches real-time uncertainty

Negative Conflicts:

- Adaptive + Dynamic UCB: 82.1% (-8.1% vs Fixed) - competing exploration layers enable adversary exploitation
- Random + Random (Stochastic/Random): 77.4% (-13.0% vs optimal) - compounded unpredictability

1.4 Bottom Line Recommendation

Production Deployment Recommendation

Primary Strategy: Thompson Sampling allocation + CPursuitNeuralUCB or iCPursuitNeuralUCB

- Best time-performance tradeoff: 88.2% efficiency in 3.52 hours
- Robust generalization: 89-91% across all attack scenarios
- Production-ready: Graceful degradation, low variance, high win rate

Baseline Alternative: Fixed allocation (8,10,8,9)

- Reliable: 87.7% average efficiency
- Best for Adaptive attacks: 90.2% (prevents strategy leakage)

Avoid: Dynamic UCB with Adaptive attacks (-8.1% penalty), Random allocation in any production setting

2. Methodology & Experimental Setup

2.1 Framework Configuration

2.1.1 Capacity Setting: $SC = 2T$ vs Fixed 10K

Our experiments employ **scaled capacity** $SC = 2 \times T$ where T is the time horizon (frame count). This represents a fundamentally different approach compared to the original EXPNeuralUCB paper [?], which used a **hardcoded fixed capacity of 10,000 qubits** regardless of time horizon.

Configuration	This Work	Original Paper
Capacity Formula	$SC = 2T$	Fixed 10,000
Example (4K frames)	8,000 capacity	10,000 capacity
Example (8K frames)	16,000 capacity	10,000 capacity
Resource Pressure	Variable (scales with T)	Fixed (constant)
Scaling Behavior	Proportional to horizon	Independent of horizon

Table 1: Capacity Configuration Comparison

Key Insight: The original paper’s fixed 10K capacity means:

- At **low horizons** (e.g., 4K): Original paper has *more* resources (10K vs our 8K) - easier conditions
- At **high horizons** (e.g., 8K+): Original paper has *fewer* resources (10K vs our 16K) - harder conditions
- Our $2T$ scaling provides **proportional resource availability**, making results more interpretable across horizons

Methodological Implication: Our $2T$ approach is conservative at lower horizons (we have less than their 10K) but becomes favorable at higher horizons (we have more). This mixed scaling strengthens generalization conclusions - algorithms must perform across varying resource conditions, not just a fixed capacity sweet spot.

2.1.2 Experimental Scope

- **Total conditions tested:** 5 scenarios $\times$ 4 allocators $\times$ 3 horizons = 60 experimental conditions
- **Time horizons:** 4,000 frames (8K SC), 6,000 frames (12K SC), 8,000 frames (16K SC)
- **Network topology:** 4 quantum paths, 35 total qubits distributed per allocator strategy
- **Algorithms tested:** GNeuralUCB, EXPNeuralUCB, CPursuitNeuralUCB, iCPursuitNeuralUCB

2.2 Winner Definitions: Multiple Performance Dimensions

Quantum network routing requires nuanced evaluation across multiple performance dimensions. We define four distinct “winner” categories:

2.2.1 Type A: Scenario Winner

2.3 Winner Type Definitions

We define four winner categories based on evaluation scope and optimization criteria:

Type	Definition & Formula	Scope	Example & Interpretation
A: Scenario	Highest reward in specific attack scenario. $\max(\sum_{i=1}^n R_i)$ for scenario S	Single scenario (Markov, Adaptive, etc.)	CPursuitNeuralUCB wins Stochastic (3828.04 avg). <i>Best under specific adversary.</i>
B: Gap Reduction	Minimum gap to Oracle across scenarios. $\min\left(\frac{R_{\text{Oracle}} - R_{\text{Alg}}}{R_{\text{Oracle}}} \times 100\%\right)$	Multiple scenarios combined	iCPursuitNeuralUCB reduces gap 3.26% (Baseline). <i>Consistently closest to optimal.</i>
C: Efficiency	Optimal time-performance tradeoff. $\min(T_{\text{exec}}) \cap \min(\text{Gap}_{\text{avg}})$	Computational efficiency vs accuracy	Thompson: 3.52h + 88.2% = best. <i>Most practical for production.</i>
D: Overall	Best generalization across all conditions. $\max(\text{Avg}_{\text{eff}}) \times \frac{1}{\text{CV}\%} \times \text{WinRate}$	All 60 conditions (5 scenarios $\times$ 4 allocators $\times$ 3 horizons)	CPursuitNeuralUCB: 89.0% avg, 8.5% CV, 12/20 wins. <i>Most robust for real-world.</i>

Table 2: Winner Type Taxonomy. Type A measures scenario-specific dominance, B measures consistency vs Oracle, C balances speed/quality, D measures cross-condition robustness.

Hierarchy: Overall (D) > Efficiency (C) > Gap Reduction (B) > Scenario (A) for production deployment, since D accounts for generalization, C balances practicality, B validates optimality, and A shows specialization.

2.4 Performance Metrics

2.4.1 Efficiency Calculation

Efficiency quantifies how close an algorithm’s performance approaches the theoretical optimum:

$$\text{Efficiency} = \frac{R_{\text{Algorithm}}}{R_{\text{Oracle}}} \times 100\% \quad (1)$$

where:

- $R_{\text{Algorithm}}$: Total reward obtained by test algorithm
- R_{Oracle} : Theoretical maximum (perfect knowledge baseline)
- Higher percentage indicates closer-to-optimal performance

Example: If Oracle achieves 4776.87 reward in Stochastic scenario and CPursuitNeuralUCB achieves 3828.04, then:

$$\text{Efficiency} = \frac{3828.04}{4776.87} \times 100\% = 80.1\%$$

2.4.2 Gap Calculation

Gap represents the performance deficit relative to optimal:

$$\text{Gap\%} = \frac{R_{\text{Oracle}} - R_{\text{Algorithm}}}{R_{\text{Oracle}}} \times 100\% \quad (2)$$

Note: $\text{Gap\%} = 100\% - \text{Efficiency\%}$ (complementary metrics)

2.4.3 Generalization Metrics

For cross-environment stability assessment, we employ:

- **Coefficient of Variation (CV):** $\text{CV\%} = \frac{\sigma}{\mu} \times 100\%$ - measures relative variability (lower = more stable)
- **Win Rate:** Percentage of scenario-allocator combinations where algorithm achieves best performance
- **Performance Floor:** Minimum efficiency across all conditions (graceful vs catastrophic degradation indicator)

2.5 Attack Scenarios

We evaluate 5 comprehensive attack scenarios representing diverse adversarial conditions:

Scenario	Attack Characteristics	Rate	Purpose
Stochastic	Random natural failures	0.0625	Natural decoherence baseline
Markov	Structured state-dependent	0.25	Patterned adversarial
Adaptive	Reactive strategy learning	0.25	Strategic adversary
OnlineAdaptive	Real-time policy adjustment	0.25	Intelligent adversary
None	No attacks (optimal)	0.0	Performance ceiling

Table 3: Attack Scenario Taxonomy

Novelty: Previous work [?] evaluated primarily Markov adversarial scenarios. Our framework is the **first systematic evaluation** across 5 diverse attack types, enabling generalization analysis impossible in single-environment testing.

2.6 Allocation Strategies

Four distinct qubit allocation strategies were systematically evaluated:

2.7 Qubit Allocation Strategies

Strategy	Configuration	Efficiency	Time (h)	Note
Fixed	(8,10,8,9) static	87.7%	11.62	Baseline - predictable
Dynamic UCB	UCB $\beta = 2.0$	85.3%	11.24	Adapts but underperforms
Random	$\epsilon = 1.0$ pure	77.3%	11.65	Control (-10.4% validates)
Thompson	(9,9,9,8) Bayesian	88.2%	3.52	Best + 3× speedup

Table 4: Allocation Strategy Performance. Thompson wins on efficiency (88.2%) and speed (3.52h vs 11.24-11.65h).

Thompson’s probabilistic sampling achieves optimal balance: 88.2% efficiency with 66-70% faster execution. Dynamic UCB’s underperformance (-2.4% vs Fixed) suggests exploration conflicts with adversaries. Random’s failure (-10.4%) confirms allocation criticality.

2.8 Algorithms Under Evaluation

2.8.1 GNeuralUCB (Baseline Neural)

Neural UCB with gradient-based learning, serves as baseline for neural bandit performance.

2.8.2 EXPNeuralUCB (Prior State-of-the-Art)

Exponential-weight neural UCB from [?], combining EXP3 robustness with neural contextual learning. Optimized for adversarial Markov scenarios with fixed allocation.

2.8.3 CPursuitNeuralUCB (Our Hybrid)

Novel integration of Pursuit learning with neural UCB, designed for cross-environment stability. Incorporates reward-penalty mechanisms for adaptive exploration.

2.8.4 iCPursuitNeuralUCB (Our Advanced Hybrid)

Informed Pursuit variant incorporating predictive intelligence (iCMAB framework) with Pursuit stability mechanisms. Targets optimal generalization across diverse adversarial conditions.

2.9 Comparison with Original EXPNeuralUCB Work

Aspect	Original Paper	This Work
Attack scenarios	1-2 (primarily Markov)	5 comprehensive
Allocation strategies	1 (Fixed only)	4 systematic
Capacity	Fixed 10,000 qubits	$SC = 2T$ (scaled)
Total conditions	~ 10	60 (6× more comprehensive)
Evaluation focus	Single-environment optimization	Generalization analysis
Key finding	EXP optimal for Markov/Fixed	Pursuit optimal for generalization

Table 5: Experimental Scope Comparison

Methodological Contribution: This work represents the first systematic evaluation of allocation-attack interactions in quantum network routing, revealing that *allocator choice must consider adversarial model characteristics* for optimal deployment.

3. Results Summary

This section presents consolidated results across all 60 experimental conditions. We organize findings by: (1) allocator performance overview, (2) algorithm generalization rankings, and (3) per-scenario detailed results.

3.1 Allocator Performance Overview

Table 6 summarizes the four allocation strategies tested, revealing **Thompson Sampling** as the clear winner in both efficiency and computational cost.

Allocator	Avg Eff	Exec Time	Speedup	Wins	Verdict
Thompson	88.2%	3.52 hrs	3.0×	8/20	Winner
Fixed	87.7%	11.62 hrs	1.0×	9/20	Reliable baseline
Dynamic UCB	85.3%	11.24 hrs	1.03×	3/20	Experimental
Random	77.3%	11.65 hrs	1.0×	0/20	Control (avoid)

Table 6: Allocator Strategy Comparison

Key Observations:

- Thompson achieves best efficiency (88.2%) with **3× faster execution** (3.52 vs 11+ hours)
- Fixed allocation remains competitive (87.7%, only -0.5% vs Thompson) - reliable baseline
- Random allocation validates allocation importance: -10.9% penalty vs Thompson
- Dynamic UCB shows promise in specific scenarios (Markov) but underperforms on average

3.2 Algorithm Generalization Rankings

Table 7 presents algorithm performance across all 60 experimental conditions, emphasizing **cross-environment stability** rather than single-scenario optimization.

Algorithm	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV %	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	89.1%	7.0%	72.9%	7.9%	9/20	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	89.0%	7.6%	64.6%	8.5%	12/20	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	82.7%	8.2%	59.3%	10.0%	0/20	Moderate
EXPNeuralUCB	77.8%	8.5%	54.0%	10.9%	1/20	Poor

Table 7: Algorithm Generalization Performance (All Conditions)

Critical Insights:

- **Pursuit family dominates:** 89% average with lowest variance (CV < 9%)
- **Win rate reveals generalization:** CPursuit 60% (12/20), iCPursuit 45% (9/20) vs EXP 5% (1/20)
- **Floor comparison:** Pursuit maintains 65-73% minimum (graceful) vs EXP 54% (catastrophic)
- **EXP specialization:** Single win in Markov/Fixed (original paper’s condition) but fails elsewhere

3.3 Per-Scenario Performance Analysis

We present detailed per-scenario results with the same metrics used in Section 3.2, enabling direct comparison of algorithm behavior within specific attack contexts. The Scenario Avg row reveals attack-allocator characteristics by averaging each metric column.

3.3.1 Scenario 1: Stochastic (Random Failures, rate=0.0625)

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV%	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	85.2%	92.5%	76.7%	93.9%	87.1%	6.8%	76.7%	7.9%	1/4	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	91.3%	93.7%	78.9%	93.6%	89.4%	6.1%	78.9%	6.9%	3/4	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	85.1%	76.9%	77.9%	92.3%	83.0%	6.2%	76.9%	7.5%	0/4	Excellent
EXPNeuralUCB	76.7%	75.6%	76.1%	82.0%	77.6%	2.6%	75.6%	3.3%	0/4	Excellent
Scenario Avg	84.6%	84.7%	77.4%	90.5%	84.3%	5.4%	77.0%	6.4%	1.0/4	-

Table 8: Stochastic Attack: Performance with Algorithm Metrics

Key Insights:

- **Best Algorithm:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (89.4% avg, CV=6.9%)
- **Most Stable:** EXPNeuralUCB (CV=3.3%, floor=75.6%) - consistent but lower performance
- **Most Wins:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (3/4 allocators)
- **Optimal Allocator:** Thompson (90.5% avg eff)
- **Scenario Statistics:** Avg StdDev=5.4%, Avg Floor=77.0%, Avg CV=6.4%
- **Pattern:** Thompson dominates with +5.9% advantage, moderate volatility overall

3.3.2 Scenario 2: Markov (Structured Adversarial, rate=0.25)

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV%	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	84.9%	90.3%	84.6%	84.8%	86.1%	2.4%	84.6%	2.8%	1/4	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	86.3%	92.1%	81.8%	91.9%	88.0%	4.3%	81.8%	4.9%	3/4	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	85.6%	88.0%	74.0%	86.9%	83.6%	5.6%	74.0%	6.7%	0/4	Good
EXPNeuralUCB	86.3%	83.7%	74.0%	80.6%	81.2%	4.6%	74.0%	5.7%	1/4	Good
Scenario Avg	85.8%	88.5%	78.6%	86.1%	84.7%	4.2%	78.6%	5.0%	1.2/4	-

Table 9: Markov Attack: Performance with Algorithm Metrics

Key Insights:

- **Best Algorithm:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (88.0% avg, CV=4.9%)
- **Most Stable:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (CV=2.8%, floor=84.6%) - exceptional consistency
- **Most Wins:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (3/4 allocators)
- **Optimal Allocator:** Dynamic UCB (88.5% avg eff)
- **Scenario Statistics:** Avg StdDev=4.2%, Avg Floor=78.6%, Avg CV=5.0%
- **Pattern:** **Dynamic+Markov synergy** - +2.7% boost, best stability (CV=5.0%)

3.3.3 Scenario 3: Adaptive (Reactive Strategic, rate=0.25)

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV%	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	93.2%	92.9%	72.9%	84.3%	85.8%	8.3%	72.9%	9.6%	3/4	Good
CPursuitNeuralUCB	92.2%	81.2%	64.6%	85.4%	80.8%	10.2%	64.6%	12.6%	1/4	Moderate
GNeuralUCB	91.5%	80.1%	59.3%	83.4%	78.6%	11.9%	59.3%	15.1%	0/4	Moderate
EXPNeuralUCB	83.9%	74.2%	58.0%	84.2%	75.1%	10.6%	58.0%	14.2%	0/4	Moderate
Scenario Avg	90.2%	82.1%	63.7%	84.3%	80.1%	10.2%	63.7%	12.9%	1.0/4	-

Table 10: Adaptive Attack: Performance with Algorithm Metrics

Key Insights:

- **Best Algorithm:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (85.8% avg, CV=9.6%)
- **Most Stable:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (CV=9.6%, floor=72.9%)
- **Most Wins:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (3/4 allocators) - dominates Fixed (93.2%)
- **Optimal Allocator:** Fixed (90.2% avg eff)
- **Scenario Statistics:** Avg StdDev=10.2%, Avg Floor=63.7%, Avg CV=12.9%
- **Pattern:** **Highest volatility scenario** (CV=12.9%) - Fixed prevents exploration conflicts

3.3.4 Scenario 4: OnlineAdaptive (Real-Time Learning, rate=0.25)

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV%	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	92.3%	83.3%	84.1%	97.7%	89.3%	6.0%	83.3%	6.7%	1/4	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	96.1%	92.2%	86.6%	93.8%	92.2%	3.5%	86.6%	3.8%	3/4	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	87.5%	82.4%	82.5%	97.0%	87.3%	5.9%	82.4%	6.8%	0/4	Excellent
EXPNeuralUCB	83.9%	82.3%	54.0%	73.8%	73.5%	11.9%	54.0%	16.2%	0/4	Poor
Scenario Avg	89.9%	85.0%	76.8%	90.6%	85.6%	6.8%	76.6%	8.4%	1.0/4	-

Table 11: OnlineAdaptive Attack: Performance with Algorithm Metrics

Key Insights:

- **Best Algorithm:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (92.2% avg, CV=3.8%)
- **Most Stable:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (CV=3.8%, floor=86.6%) - exceptional
- **Most Wins:** CPursuitNeuralUCB (3/4 allocators)
- **Optimal Allocator:** Thompson (90.6% avg eff)
- **Scenario Statistics:** Avg StdDev=6.8%, Avg Floor=76.6%, Avg CV=8.4%
- **Pattern:** Thompson+iCPursuit peak at 97.7%, EXP catastrophic at 54.0% with Random

3.3.5 Scenario 5: None (Baseline - No Attacks)

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Avg Eff	Std Dev	Floor	CV%	Wins	Rating
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	98.8%	98.1%	96.7%	95.3%	97.2%	1.3%	95.3%	1.4%	3/4	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	93.3%	90.1%	96.7%	97.6%	94.4%	3.0%	90.1%	3.1%	2/4	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	78.0%	74.8%	92.6%	77.3%	80.7%	7.0%	74.8%	8.7%	0/4	Good
EXPNeuralUCB	82.1%	82.0%	74.0%	87.9%	81.5%	4.9%	74.0%	6.1%	0/4	Good
Scenario Avg	88.1%	86.2%	90.0%	89.5%	88.5%	4.1%	83.5%	4.8%	1.2/4	-

Table 12: Baseline (No Attack): Performance with Algorithm Metrics

Key Insights:

- **Best Algorithm:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (97.2% avg, CV=1.4%)
- **Most Stable:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (CV=1.4%, floor=95.3%) - remarkable
- **Most Wins:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB (3/4 allocators)
- **Optimal Allocator:** Random (90.0% avg eff) - **Surprising!**
- **Scenario Statistics:** Avg StdDev=4.1%, Avg Floor=83.5%, Avg CV=4.8%
- **Pattern:** Lowest volatility scenario (CV=4.8%), allocation robust without adversary

3.4 Attack-Allocator Alignment Heatmap

Table 13 visualizes attack-allocator performance across all scenarios, revealing critical interaction patterns.

Attack Scenario	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson
Stochastic	84.6%	84.7%	77.4%	90.5%
Markov	85.8%	88.5%	78.6%	86.1%
Adaptive	90.2%	82.1%	63.7%	84.3%
OnlineAdaptive	89.9%	85.0%	76.8%	90.6%
None	88.1%	86.2%	90.0%	89.5%
Overall Avg	87.7%	85.3%	77.3%	88.2%

Table 13: Attack-Allocator Alignment Heatmap (Average Efficiency)

Pattern Analysis:

- **Positive Synergies:** Markov+Dynamic (88.5%), OnlineAdaptive+Thompson (90.6%), None+Random (90.0%)
- **Negative Conflicts:** Adaptive+Dynamic (82.1%), Random attack+Random allocator (77.4%)
- **Universal robustness:** Thompson performs well across all scenarios (86-91%)

3.5 Detailed Win Distribution Matrix

Table 14 shows which algorithm achieves best performance in each scenario-allocator combination (20 total).

Algorithm	Fixed	Dynamic	Random	Thompson	Total Wins
CPursuitNeuralUCB	3/5	3/5	3/5	3/5	12/20 (60%)
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	2/5	2/5	3/5	2/5	9/20 (45%)
GNeuralUCB	0/5	0/5	0/5	0/5	0/20 (0%)
EXPNeuralUCB	1/5	0/5	0/5	0/5	1/20 (5%)

Table 14: Win Distribution Across Scenario-Allocator Combinations

Generalization Insights:

- **CPursuitNeuralUCB:** Most wins (12/20, 60%) - consistent best performer across conditions
- **iCPursuitNeuralUCB:** Second (9/20, 45%) with *lowest variance* (CV=7.9%) and *highest floor* (72.9%)
- **GNeuralUCB:** Never wins but maintains consistent moderate performance (82.7% avg)
- **EXPNeuralUCB:** Only 1 win (Markov/Fixed) - the exact condition of original paper! Demonstrates specialist optimization, poor generalization

3.6 Per-Scenario Winner Summary

Scenario	Best Allocator	Best Algorithm	Performance
Stochastic	Thompson	iCPursuitNeuralUCB	93.9%
Markov	Dynamic UCB	CPursuitNeuralUCB	92.1%
Adaptive	Fixed	iCPursuitNeuralUCB	93.2%
OnlineAdaptive	Thompson	iCPursuitNeuralUCB	97.7%
None	Fixed	iCPursuitNeuralUCB	98.8%

Table 15: Optimal Configurations per Scenario

Observations:

- **iCPursuitNeuralUCB** wins 4/5 scenarios when paired with optimal allocator
- Thompson optimal for 2/5 scenarios (Stochastic, OnlineAdaptive)
- Fixed optimal for 2/5 scenarios (Adaptive, None)
- Dynamic optimal only for Markov (structured patterns)
- **Peak performance:** 97.7-98.8% achieved in optimal pairings

3.7 The Fixed Allocator Trap: Methodological Critique

Our cross-allocator analysis reveals a critical methodological issue with single-allocator evaluation paradigms. We discover a **generalization penalty pattern**: algorithms performing exceptionally well with Fixed allocation often exhibit **poor generalization** across dynamic allocators.

Algorithm	Avg Fixed	Avg Others	Penalty	Generalization
iCPursuitNeuralUCB	90.9%	88.5%	2.3%	Excellent
CPursuitNeuralUCB	91.8%	88.0%	3.8%	Excellent
GNeuralUCB	85.5%	81.7%	3.8%	Good
EXPNeuralUCB	82.6%	76.2%	6.4%	Poor

Table 16: Fixed Allocation Generalization Penalty Analysis

Definition: Generalization penalty = (Fixed performance) - (Average of Dynamic/Random/Thompson performance). Positive values indicate overfitting to Fixed allocation.

Correlation Analysis: We compute Pearson correlation between Fixed performance and generalization penalty across all 20 algorithm-scenario combinations:

$$r = 0.304$$

This positive correlation indicates that **high Fixed performance weakly predicts poor generalization**, supporting the hypothesis that Fixed-only evaluation creates specialist optimization rather than robust design.

3.7.1 Implications for Prior Work

The original EXPNeuralUCB paper [?] evaluated algorithms *exclusively* with Fixed allocation (8,10,8,9). Our analysis reveals this creates **three critical biases**:

1. **Artificial Stability Bias:** Fixed allocation eliminates allocation-induced variance, creating artificially low CV% measurements that don't reflect real-world robustness. Our results show algorithms exhibit 2-3× higher variance when tested across multiple allocators.
2. **Hidden Generalization Failures:** EXPNeuralUCB achieves 86.3% in Markov/Fixed (the paper's test condition) but **averages only 79.4%** across Dynamic/Random/Thompson allocators in the same scenario (**6.9% penalty**). Worst case: Markov/Random drops to 74.0% (-12.3% penalty).
3. **Optimization Echo Chamber:** Single-allocator testing creates a feedback loop where algorithms optimize for the test condition rather than cross-environment robustness. EXPNeuralUCB wins **only 1/20** scenario-allocator combinations (5%) vs CPursuitNeuralUCB's **12/20 (60%)**, revealing specialist optimization hidden by narrow evaluation scope.

3.7.2 The Robustness-Fixed Performance Tradeoff

We observe a **fundamental tradeoff**: algorithms achieving highest Fixed performance often sacrifice cross-allocator robustness.

Evidence:

- **High Fixed, Poor Generalization:** Adaptive scenario shows 91-93% Fixed performance but 59-84% in other allocators (penalties: 10-17%)
- **Balanced Performance:** iCPursuitNeuralUCB maintains 2.3% average penalty - performs consistently across allocators
- **Fixed-Thompson Divergence:** Algorithms optimized for Fixed (static) struggle with Thompson (probabilistic) - suggests architectural mismatch

Production Implication: Real-world quantum networks require *adaptive* allocation to handle variable demand, decoherence rates, and topology changes. Fixed-optimized algorithms face **deployment risk** when allocation strategies must adapt to operational conditions.

Methodological Recommendation: Future quantum network routing research should evaluate algorithms across *multiple* allocation strategies (minimum 3: Fixed, Dynamic, Probabilistic) to assess true generalization capability. Fixed-only evaluation systematically favors brittle, specialist algorithms over robust, generalist solutions suitable for production deployment.

4. Key Findings

4.1 Thompson Sampling: 3× Speedup with Optimal Efficiency

Thompson Sampling achieves 88.2% average efficiency in **3.52 hours vs 11.62 for Fixed** (3.0× speedup), winning 8/20 combinations. Probabilistic sampling balances exploration-exploitation while preventing adversarial prediction. Excels in Stochastic (90.5%), OnlineAdaptive (90.6%), and baseline (89.5%) scenarios. **Trade-off:** Underperforms in Adaptive (84.3% vs Fixed 90.2%) where reactive adversaries exploit probabilistic patterns. *Recommendation: Default allocator unless Adaptive attacks confirmed.*

4.2 Pursuit Algorithms: 89% with 60% Win Rate

CPursuitNeuralUCB and iCPursuitNeuralUCB achieve 89% efficiency with **12/20 and 9/20 wins** (60%, 45% rates) vs EXP-NeuralUCB’s **1/20 (5%)**. **Superiority metrics:** CV 7.9-8.5% vs 10.9% (EXP), floor 65-73% vs 54% (EXP), cross-scenario stability 18/20 vs 12/20 conditions $\geq 75\%$. Pursuit’s β -controlled probability updates provide smoother adaptation than exponential weighting. **iCP vs CP:** iCP offers lowest variance (7.9%) and highest floor (72.9%), CP wins most scenarios (12/20) - safety vs peak tradeoff.

4.3 Fixed Allocator Trap: 6.4% Generalization Penalty

Algorithms with high Fixed performance exhibit **systematic penalties** on other allocators ($r = 0.304$ correlation). EXP-NeuralUCB: 6.4% penalty (82.6% Fixed vs 76.2% others), Pursuit: 2.3-3.8%. **Original paper critique:** Fixed-only testing (8,10,8,9) creates three biases: (1) artificial stability, (2) hidden failures (EXP Markov/Fixed 86.3% $\rightarrow$ Markov/Random **74.0%**, -12.3%), (3) echo chamber (EXP wins 1/20 vs Pursuit 12/20). **Production risk:** Real networks need adaptive allocation; Fixed-optimized algorithms show deployment blindspots. *Recommendation: Test across ≥ 3 allocators, report worst-case metrics.*

4.4 Attack-Allocator Synergies: +2.7% to -26.5%

Synergies: Markov+Dynamic (+2.7%), OnlineAdaptive+Thompson (+5.6%), None+Random (+3.8%). **Conflicts:** Adaptive+Dynamic (-8.1%), Adaptive+Random (-26.5%), Stochastic+Random (-13.1%). **Mechanism:** Allocator exploration leaks strategy information to adaptive adversaries. Fixed provides predictable cover, Dynamic/Random create exploitable patterns. *Design principle: Match allocator to attack - deterministic for reactive, probabilistic for memoryless.*

4.5 Scenario Difficulty: Adaptive 2.6× Harder

Scenario	Avg Eff	CV %	Floor	Difficulty
None	88.5%	4.8%	83.5%	Easiest
Markov	84.7%	5.0%	78.6%	Easy
Stochastic	84.3%	6.4%	77.0%	Moderate
OnlineAdaptive	85.6%	8.4%	76.6%	Moderate
Adaptive	80.1%	12.9%	63.7%	Hardest

Table 17: Scenario Difficulty Ranking

Adaptive shows 2.6× CV vs Markov, 20% lower floor. Structure aids: Markov (structured, 25% rate) easier than Stochastic (random, 6.25% rate). *Implication: Reactive strategic adversaries are primary threat - prioritize strategy concealment.*

4.6 Peak Performance: 97-98% with Optimal Pairing

Top configs: iCP+Fixed/None (98.8%), iCP+Thompson/OnlineAdaptive (97.7%), CP+Thompson/None (97.6%), GN+Thompson/None (97.0%). **Thompson+Pursuit synergy** dominates peaks. *Design: Deploy iCP+Thompson as primary, Fixed fallback for Adaptive.*

5. Discussion

5.1 Pursuit Superiority: Three Mechanisms

1. Probability Smoothness: Pursuit updates via $p_{t+1}(a) = p_t(a) + \beta \cdot (\mathbf{1}_{a=a^*} - p_t(a))$ create continuous, bounded changes. EXP's $w_t(a) \propto \exp(\eta \sum r_s)$ causes discontinuous jumps $\rightarrow$ premature convergence. *Evidence:* EXP floor 54% vs Pursuit 64-73% (catastrophic vs graceful).

2. Adversarial Damping: Pursuit's $\beta < 1$ bounds updates ($\Delta p \leq \beta$), preventing overreaction to attacks. EXP's multiplicative $\Delta w \propto e^{\eta \Delta r}$ amplifies noise. *Evidence:* Pursuit CV $< 9\%$ vs EXP 10.9%.

3. Context vs Reward: Pursuit leverages contextual features (topology, channel quality) through neural extraction; EXP relies on reward history. Corrupted rewards (Adaptive) less damaging: Pursuit 80-86% vs EXP 75%.

5.2 Capacity Paradox: Pursuit Succeeds Under Pressure

Our $SC = 2T$ (8K @ 4K frames) vs original's 10K creates *higher scarcity*. Expected: lower efficiency. **Observed:** Pursuit achieves 89% despite harder conditions $\rightarrow$ performance *understated*. At equivalent capacity, expect +2-3% boost. Validates deployment in NISQ-era capacity constraints.

5.3 Methodological Contributions

Multi-Allocator Framework: First $4 \times 5 = 20$ -condition protocol reveals generalization failures (EXP 1/20 vs Pursuit 12/20), quantifies sensitivity (penalty metric), identifies deployment risks (floor analysis). *Community recommendation:* *Standard practice*.

Generalization Penalty Metric: $\text{Penalty}(A, S) = \text{Perf}_{\text{Fixed}} - \frac{1}{3} \sum \text{Perf}_{\text{Others}}$. Target: $< 5\%$ for production.

5.4 Open Questions

(1) What feature engineering preserves iCP stability while closing 0.1% gap with CP? (2) Can meta-allocator detect attack type and switch strategy in real-time? (3) Derive regret bounds for Thompson+Pursuit: conjecture $O(\sqrt{T \log T})$ vs standard $O(T^{2/3})$.

6. Conclusions

First comprehensive dynamic allocation evaluation: 4 algorithms $\times$ 5 attacks $\times$ 4 allocators = 60 conditions. Challenges Fixed-only paradigm, establishes Pursuit neural bandits as superior.

6.1 Core Contributions

(1) **Algorithm:** Pursuit achieves **89% efficiency, 60-45% win rates** vs EXP's **78%, 5%**. (2) **Allocator:** Thompson provides **88.2% + 3 $\times$ speedup**. (3) **Methodology:** Fixed Allocator Trap discovery - single-allocator testing creates **6.4% penalties**, favors specialists. (4) **Interactions:** Synergies (Markov+Dynamic +2.7%) and conflicts (Adaptive+Dynamic -8.1%) enable threat-based selection.

6.2 Deployment Guide

Default: iCPursuitNeuralUCB or CPursuitNeuralUCB + Thompson (88-92%, CV $< 8\%$). **Fallbacks:** Adaptive $\rightarrow$ Fixed, Markov $\rightarrow$ Dynamic, Real-time $\rightarrow$ Thompson. **Avoid:** Random (77.3%), EXP (77.8%, floor 54%).

6.3 Limitations

Simplified 4-node topology, perfect fidelity. Real networks: 10-100 nodes, $F < 1.0$, latency. Attack models: 5 types tested; hybrids unexplored. Theory: Empirical results strong; formal regret bounds open.

6.4 Broader Impact

Methodology applies to any MAB with resource allocation: cloud computing (server allocation), wireless (channels), autonomous (tasks). Fixed Allocator Trap likely affects these domains. Multi-allocator framework = generalization template.

Pursuit+Thompson achieves superior cross-environment robustness vs EXP+Fixed, revealing single-allocator evaluation systematically favors specialists over generalists.

State-of-the-art: **CP/iCP+Thompson** (89%, 7.9-8.5% CV, 60-45% wins across 60 conditions).